

CEO

Catherine Voss, Master of the Universe

CEO · EXECUTIVE



HIRE

◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Financials funding source.

Once each turn, you may turn up to 3 Leverage into Surplus, one for one.

If you become insolvent, every other company loses 5 Surplus.

Advises both sides of every deal, bills them both, and knows the bailout number by heart.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 218 / 374

OFFICE LOCATION

New York

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 4 branch only

Litigation

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

The first Investment you play on your turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

The deal closes before the lunch reservation does.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 350 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

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ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



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MARGIN

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NO. 036 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

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MARGIN

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NO. 036 / 374

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Investor Capital

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Equity

Staple: any number per deck.

Limited partners are patient right up until the market isn't.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 036 / 374

FUNDING SOURCE

Private Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½ each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 374

Private Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½ each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 374

Private Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½ each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 374

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 374

Margin Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

At the end of your turn, you can keep only 1 Margin Credit for every 10 Surplus you have. Discard the rest.

Your prime broker's favorite customer, right up until the collateral call.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 037 / 374

Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Rates

Staple: any number per deck.

A third of your Retail Deposits, rounded down, have no exposure.

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Checking, savings, and a free toaster: the cheapest money in finance, until it all wants out at once.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 034 / 374

Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Rates

Staple: any number per deck.

A third of your Retail Deposits, rounded down, have no exposure.

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Checking, savings, and a free toaster: the cheapest money in finance, until it all wants out at once.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 034 / 374

Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

STAPLE

▲ Short-Term Rates

Staple: any number per deck.

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NO. 034 / 374

Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



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Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



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ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 034 / 374

Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 Turn start

STAPLE

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F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 034 / 374

Private Equity

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 3

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

No distributions yet, which the fund calls the J-curve.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 052 / 374

Dynamic Hedging Program

TREATY



COST

◆ 3

CARRYING COST

● 1 each turn

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires an Annuity or Financials funding source.

Halve your loss from Short-Term Equity, Long-Term Equity, and Volatility clauses (round down).

The hedge works perfectly, except when the market moves.

A

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 116 / 374

Research Analyst

FRONT LINE



HIRE

◆ 4

Requires a Financials funding source.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Publishes forty pages a day, of which occasionally one is right.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 225 / 374

Trading Algorithm

SOFTWARE



PRICE

◆ 3

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Whenever a Market Stress Test resolves, gain 2 Surplus.

Destroyed if Flash Crash hits you.

Made money every second of the backtest, and for the first forty-five minutes of the real thing.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 368 / 374

Corporate Spy

FRONT LINE

DARK



HIRE

◆ 2

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Each opponent's maximum hand size is 1 lower.

Badge says Facilities, laptop says otherwise.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 214 / 374

Margin Call

LIQUIDITY



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 2 per Volatility exposure, and 2 per investment they control.

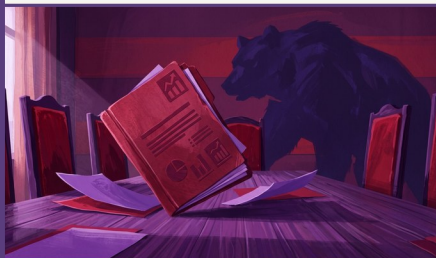
The broker would like a word, and also your cash.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 276 / 374

Short-Seller Report

REPUTATION



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 2 Surplus per investment they control and 1 per Dark card on their board, plus 4 more.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Blockchain Co. it controls.

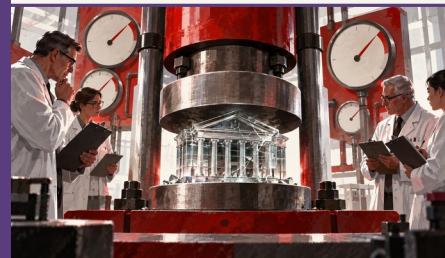
Ninety-four pages, a catchy name, and a very bad morning for investor relations.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 279 / 374

Supervisory Stress Test

REGULATION



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

▲ Credit ▲ Liquidity

Target opponent loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure, 3 per Liquidity exposure, and 1 per Dark card on their board. Then they can't add a funding source on their next turn.

The regulators ran their annual stress test, and this year you were the stress.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 305 / 374

Whistleblower

CORPORATE



COST

◆ 3

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Dark card in their discard pile.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Shell Company, Feeder Fund, Affiliate Loan, or Guaranteed Returns Fund it controls.

She kept copies of everything, including the email telling her not to.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 298 / 374

M&A Advisory

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SIGNATURE ILLIQUID

▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck; Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if a Market Stress Test hits you.

Every merger is a match made in heaven, at least until the fees clear.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 079 / 374

Prime Brokerage

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Credit

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

Lends hedge funds the money to buy the stock that secures the loan.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 078 / 374

Data Center Loans

ILLIQUID



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

AI ILLIQUID

▲ Credit

AI: AI Bubble Bursts destroys it; Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Secured by a warehouse of chips and one tenant with a very bold revenue forecast.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 098 / 374

Trading Desk

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if a Market Stress Test hits you.

Buys low, sells high, and has a very good explanation for the other days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 080 / 374

Off-Balance-Sheet Vehicle

COVER

DARK



COST

◆ 1

DARK SIGNATURE COVER

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile; Signature: one copy per deck; Cover: discard it if that card leaves play.

You may pay Surplus instead of Leverage to play this card.

Attach to one of your investments. Its exposures don't count.

Destroyed if Enron Implodes hits you.

It's not our debt, it's the box's. We just own the box, guarantee the box, and named it.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 150 / 374

Subsidiary CDS

TREATY



COST

◆ 1

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Financials funding source.

When Credit clauses cost you Surplus, regain up to 6 of it. Then discard this.

Destroyed if Chainsaw AI at Sunbeam hits you.

Protection on a subsidiary that, as of this morning, owes nobody anything.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 155 / 374

Creditor-on-Creditor-Violence Liability Management Exercise

CORPORATE



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Credit

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 3 Surplus per Credit exposure and 3 per investment they control.

The new lenders get the collateral, while the old lenders get a letter explaining what an unrestricted subsidiary is.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 309 / 374

Chicago

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 4 branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 3 Equity Futures, Commodity Futures, or Interest-Rate Futures treaties you control, combined (round down).

The weather is volatile, so the book is hedged.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 356 / 374

INVESTMENT

Inverse VIX Note

INVESTMENT

COST

◆ 5

YIELD

● 3 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ **Volatility x2**

Destroyed if Volmageddon hits you.

Collects small gains for staying short volatility, right up to one very large afternoon.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 097 / 374

RISK MANAGEMENT

Equity Futures

TREATY

COST

◆ 0

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Short-Term Equity exposures counts as Liquidity instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier Risk Management cards choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

The market risk is covered, so please post collateral by the close.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 160 / 374

RISK MANAGEMENT

Equity Futures

TREATY

COST

◆ 0

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Short-Term Equity exposures counts as Liquidity instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier Risk Management cards choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

The market risk is covered, so please post collateral by the close.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 160 / 374

TALENT

Headhunter

FRONT LINE

HIRE

◆ 3

Commit this employee to **poach** an opponent's employee. (Pay its Hire plus 2 Surplus. It gains Non-compete and arrives committed.)

Knows what everyone at your table is paid, and who would pay them more.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 229 / 374

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Asset Freeze

GEOPOLITICAL

COST

◆ 2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one Investment to discard without Sale proceeds, chosen by the runner.

The position was marked at full value right up until the moment it could not be sold, moved, or mentioned.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 336 / 374

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Lease Terminated

CORPORATE

COST

◆ 1

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one branch to discard, chosen by the runner.

The building was sold to a developer with other plans, most of them involving condominiums.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 339 / 374

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Flash Crash

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Short-Term Equity

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

On May 6, 2010, a burst of automated selling briefly wiped about a trillion dollars off the value of U.S. stocks. The Dow fell almost 1,000 points in minutes, then mostly came back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 284 / 374

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Affordable Care Act

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Regulation

Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Regulation exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In March 2010, the Affordable Care Act became law and rewrote the rules of American health insurance. Every four years, half the actuaries update their assumptions and the other half update their resumes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 250 / 374

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Volcker Shock

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1979

HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Short-Term Rates

Liquidity

Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Rates exposure, 2 per Liquidity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

In October 1979 the Federal Reserve let short-term rates climb toward 20% to break inflation, and the savings and loans that had funded 30-year mortgages with passbook savings never recovered.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 302 / 374

1906 San Francisco Earthquake

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 1906



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE **ACT OF GOD**

▲ Nat Cat: Earthquake ▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 12 Surplus per Nat Cat: Earthquake exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

Surprise trust fall.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 252 / 374

Subprime Meltdown

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2007



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Credit ▲ Property Value ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Credit exposure, 6 per Property Value exposure, and 3 per Volatility exposure.

In 2007 the adjustable-rate mortgages written with no income checks began to reset, and the loans bundled into AAA-rated bonds defaulted by the hundreds of thousands. The bonds' ratings were the last thing to go.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 304 / 374

Bird Flu Pandemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE **ACT OF GOD**

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

Talk about a viral tweet!

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 242 / 374

Quantitative Easing

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 2008



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE **ACT OF GOD**

▲ Low Interest Rates

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Low Interest Rates exposure.

In November 2008, the Federal Reserve began buying hundreds of billions of dollars of bonds to push long-term interest rates down. It was very clear about its plans, which was the problem.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 251 / 374

Sinking of the Titanic

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 1912



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Mortality exposure, plus 2 more.

Rich people buy a ton of life insurance.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 264 / 374

Solvency II

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2016



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Regulation exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Rated Feeder Note it controls.

On January 1, 2016, Solvency II took effect for insurers across the European Union, after more than a decade of consultation and several delays.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 288 / 374

Opioid Epidemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality ▲ Litigation ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure, 4 per Litigation exposure, and 4 per Health Price exposure.

Brought to you by Purdue Pharma.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 244 / 374

Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 287 / 374

2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE **ACT OF GOD**

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 234 / 374

AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE
▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.
Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.
On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.

Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD
▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.
Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.
On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.

Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE
▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.
Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.
In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.

Klarna's Down Round

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE
▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.
Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.
In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.